Towards Realistic Cut-and-Paste Object Insertion

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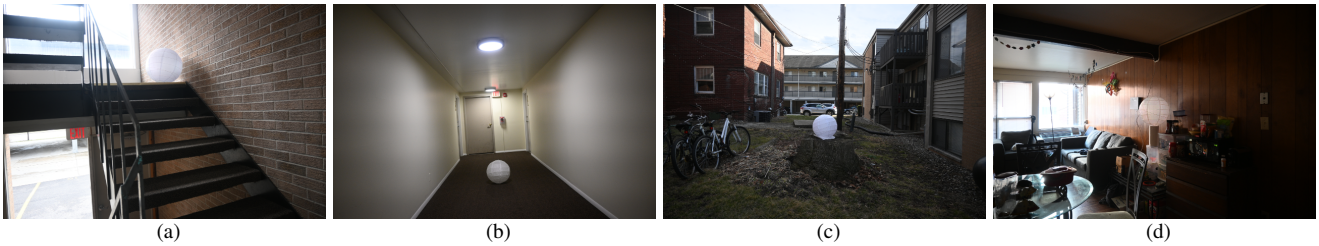


(a) (b) (c) (d)

Figure 1. In two of these images, the spherical lampshade is produced by our method creates realistically shaded renderings from cut-and-paste information; the other two are real photographs. Can you tell which is which? Answer in Sec 4.

Abstract

We show how to insert an object from one image to another and get realistic results in the hard case, where the shading of the inserted object clashes with the shading of the scene. Rendering objects using an illumination model of the scene doesn't work, because doing so requires a geometric and material model of the object, which cannot usually be recovered from a single image. In this paper, we introduce a method that corrects shading inconsistencies of the inserted object without requiring a geometric and physical model or an environment map. Our method uses a deep image prior (DIP) that is trained to produce reshaded renderings of inserted objects via consistent image decomposition inferential losses. The resulting image from DIP aims to have (a) an albedo similar to the cut-and-paste albedo, (b) a similar shading field to that of the target scene, and (c) a shading that is consistent with the cut-and-paste surface normals. The result is a simple procedure that produces convincing shading of the inserted object. We show the efficacy of our method both qualitatively and quantitatively for several objects with complex surface properties and also on a small dataset of spherical lampshades for quantitative evaluation. Our method significantly outperforms an Image Harmonization (IH) baseline for all these objects. Our renderings also outperform the cut-and-paste and IH baselines in a blind user study with over 100 users.

1. Introduction

Inserting objects into images is an appealingly easy rendering paradigm – one just moves objects from one image into another. Applications of this task are abundant, ranging from room planners to image editing for artists to training detectors [32, 11]. But most insertions are not realistic because the shading between the inserted object clashes with the target scene and the object sticks out [23]. Current state-of-the-art (SOTA) methods recover an environment map and render objects using their geometric and physical model [29, 16]. Current single-image methods for shape and material recovery cannot accurately reconstruct realistic objects (say, a lego toy) [31]. Therefore, in this work, we focus on an image-based insertion approach: one takes an object from one image, inserts it into another, and expects a system to correct it. Our method not only synthesizes plausibly realistic renderings of inserted objects with complex surface properties but also does not require a geometric or physical model or an environment map at test time. Furthermore, it does not require rendered images during training.

Our method, DIPR, uses Deep Image Prior [53] for reshading. DIPR adjusts shading so that simple inferences are consistent with cut-and-paste predictions. The rendering process produces an image that is realistic, guaranteed by our use of a deep image prior. The rendering must also produce (a) an albedo that matches the cut-and-paste albedo, (b) a shading that matches the target scene's shading outside the inserted fragment, and (c) the rendered shading and the cut-and-paste normals are consistent with each other. The result is a simple procedure that produces convincing shading. Our entire process, including image decomposition, does not require any form of labeled data for training. We use an extension of Retinex[26], build a statistical process for data generation and train variants of image decomposition models for DIPR. In fact, our only use of simulated ground truth is our use of a pre-trained, off-the-shelf, normal estimator [40].

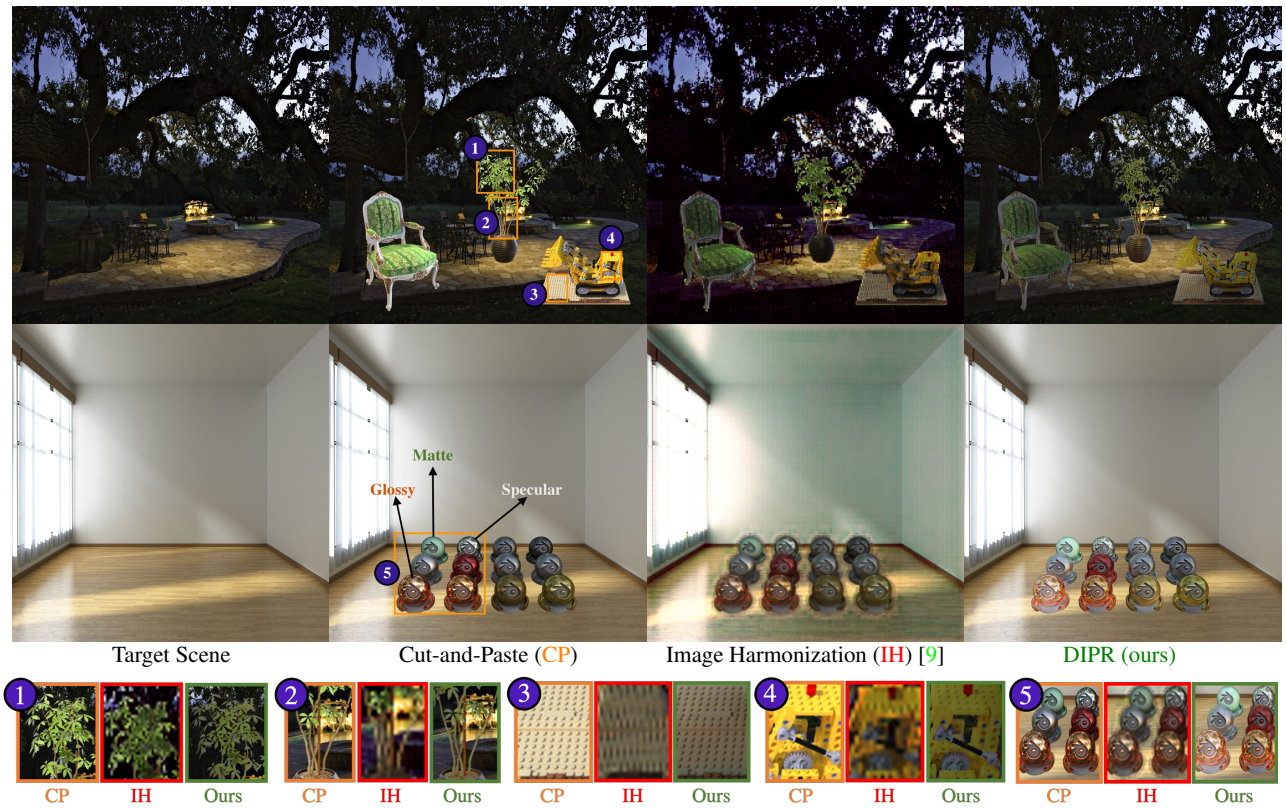


Figure 2. We synthesize realistic, high-resolution renderings of objects added to scenes – cut from one image and pasted into another. Our approach, DIPR, is entirely image-based and can convincingly insert objects with complex surface properties (a lego dozer, a plant and a chair in the first row) and matte, glossy and specular objects (a set of 16 different materials in the second row; crop#5 in bottom row) added to spatially varying illuminated scenes (indoor-outdoor, day-night) without requiring the geometry of the inserted objects or the parameters of the target scene. Key findings from our method are (a) it appears to handle complex and subtle interaction with light; for eg., leaves (crop#1) (b) it appears to understand 3D scene and illumination reasonably well (crop#2); CP in crop#2 looks realistic in local context, but it isn't capturing the 3D scene – the light source behind is far away from the plant, and (c) it preserves material properties because of a carefully designed model; enabling object insertion without any loss of high-frequency details (crop#3 & #4).

Our experiments show DIPR convincingly inserts several objects with complex surface properties – a lego dozer, a plant, a chair and a set of 16 materials with different reflective properties (Fig. 2, 10), cars (Fig. 3, 9) and spherical lampshades (Fig. 1, 8). In qualitative analysis, we show DIPR produces convincing results compared to a SOTA image harmonization baseline [9]. We also find that DIPR achieves significantly better PSNR, MSE and LPIPS scores, outperforming a SOTA image harmonization baseline for lampshades renderings (Tab. 1). We conduct user studies comparing our renderings against baselines and real images. We also show our method has an implicit notion of 3D shape as an emergent property of our consistent reshading (Fig. 14). In summary, our main contribution is a method that

- can realistically insert objects without labeled data.
- works for matte, glossy and specular objects with complex surface properties and without requiring an explicit geometric or physical model.
- works for diverse (indoor-outdoor, day-night) spatially varying illuminated complex target scenes.

2. Related Work

Object insertion originated with Lalonde *et al.* [23]. They insert objects into target images and control illumination problems by checking objects for compatibility with targets; Bansal *et al.* [1] and Lee *et al.* [28] do so by matching contexts. Poisson blending [42, 20] can resolve nasty boundary artifacts, but significant illumination and color mismatches will cause cross-talk between target and fragment, producing ugly results. Karsch *et al.* [21, 22] how convincing insertions of computer graphics (CG) objects into inverse rendering models. Inverse rendering trained with rendered images can produce excellent reshading of CG objects [44]. However, recovering a renderable model from an image fragment is extremely difficult, particularly if the fragment has an odd surface texture. Liao *et al.*[33, 34] showed that a weak geometric model of the object can be sufficient for correcting shading *if* one has strong the geometric information about the target scene. However, we do not know about geometry of the target scene, except for their normals.

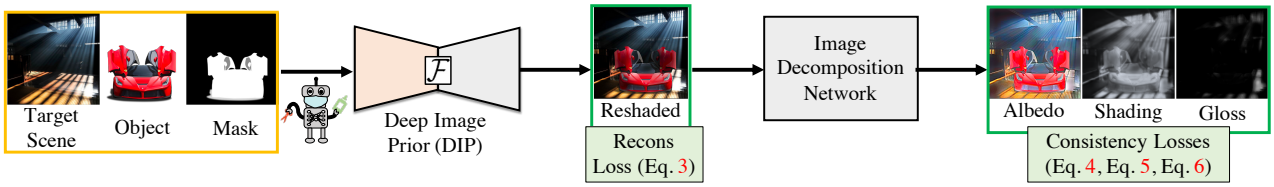


Figure 3. **DIPR overview**. DIPR generates a plausibly realistic rendering of an object inserted from a source image to a target scene. DIPR uses a DIP to generate a reshaded rendering that has consistent image decomposition inferences. The resulting rendering from DIP should have an albedo, same as the cut-and-paste albedo; it should have a shading and gloss field that, outside the inserted fragment, is the same as the target scene's shading and gloss field. The rendering must have similar spherical harmonic properties as target scene and meet a consistency test everywhere (Sec 3.2, Fig. 4). This simple procedure inserts objects convincingly in real images.

With appropriate training data (mostly for indoor scenes), one can predict single lighting for the whole scene [15], or use multiple spherical harmonics basis [16] or spherical Gaussian basis [29] to predict spatially varying lighting, or even full radiance maps at scene points [48, 49]. However, we do not have access to training data with environment maps to construct such a lighting field. Moreover, for object insertion, these methods require geometric and physical models of the inserted objects and rely on external software to render them. In contrast, DIPR is entirely image-based: one takes an object from one image, drops it into another, and expects a system to correct it without requiring a geometric or physical model. Recent single-image relighting methods relight portrait faces under directional lighting [50, 58, 41]. DIPR can reshade matte, gloss, and specular objects with complex material properties like cars (Fig. 9) for both indoor and outdoor spatially varying lighting only from a single image and without requiring physics-based BRDF for material estimation [31, 29].

We use **image harmonization** (IH) methods as a strong baseline. IH methods train models to correct corrupted images where a fragment is adjusted by some noise process (made brighter; recolored; etc.) to the original image [51, 52, 9], and so could clearly be applied here. But we find those IH methods very often change the albedo of an inserted object, rather than its shading. This is because they rely on ensuring consistency of color representations across the image. In contrast, we wish to correct shading alone.

Land's Retinex (**image decomposition**) model assumes effective albedo displays sharp, localized changes (which result in large image gradients), and that shading has small gradients [24, 25, 26, 27]. These models require no ground truth. An alternative is to use CG rendered images for training [30, 6, 12]. One can also train using rendering constraints to produce a form of self-supervised training [19]. Current image decomposition evaluation uses the weighted human disagreement rate (WHDR) [4]; current champions are [12]. We use an image decomposition built around approximate statistical models of albedo and shading (*paradigms* [13]) to train our network without requiring real image ground truth decompositions. Our method has reasonable, but not SOTA, WHDR; but we show that improvements in WHDR do not result in improvements in reshading (Fig. 7).

3. Approach

DIPR synthesizes a reshaded object transferred from the source image (s) into a target scene image (t). We use a deep image prior (DIP) [53] as a renderer to produce a reshaded image (Fig. 3). We enable DIP to reshade by forcing it to produce consistent image decomposition inferences that meet certain shading consistency tests. We use an image decomposition trained on *paradigms* (statistical samples of albedo, shading and gloss; Fig. 5a) and not real images (Sec 3.3), and surface normals inferred by the method of [40] to meet the shading consistency tests (Sec 3.2).

3.1. Enabling DIP for Reshading

Assume we have a noisy image $\mathcal{I}_t$, and wish to reconstruct the original. Write z for a random vector, and f_θ for a CNN with parameters θ and $E(f_\theta(z); \mathcal{I}_t)$ for a loss comparing the image $f_\theta(z)$ to $\mathcal{I}_t$. DIP seeks

$$\hat{\theta} = \text{argmin}_\theta E(f_\theta(z); \mathcal{I}_t) \quad (1)$$

and then reports $f_{\hat{\theta}}(z)$. We modify Eq. 1 by requiring that $E(\cdot; \mathcal{I}_t)$ impose inferential consistency. In particular, write g_ϕ for some inference network(s), $t_\psi(\mathcal{I}_s, \mathcal{I}_t)$ for inferences constructed out of $\mathcal{I}_t$ and the source image $\mathcal{I}_s$. DIPR seeks

$$\hat{\theta} = \text{argmin}_\theta E(g_\phi(f_\theta(z)); t_\psi(\mathcal{I}_s, \mathcal{I}_t)). \quad (2)$$

For us, g_ϕ is an image decomposition network (pretrained and fixed), and t_ψ creates target albedos ($\mathcal{A}_t$), shading ($\mathcal{S}_t$), and glosses ($\mathcal{G}_t$). We then train DIPR to produce an image that has reasonable intrinsic image properties. For DIPR, the input z is the cut-and-paste image and f_θ is optimized to inpaint inserted fragment and also to meet satisfactory intrinsic properties. We use U-Net with partial convolution [36, 47]. However, we find the standard partial convolution converges to a trivial solution, producing images close to cut-and-paste. To prevent this overfitting, we flip the context for partial convolution. We consider the inserted object(s) as the context and hallucinate/outpaint the entire target scene around it. We call this *flipped partial convolution*.

We use $\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s; \mathcal{I}_t; s)$ for an operator that cuts the fragment out of the source image $\mathcal{I}_s$, scales it by s, and places it in the relevant location in the target image $\mathcal{I}_t$. $\mathcal{M}$ for a mask with the size of the target image that is 0 inside the fragment

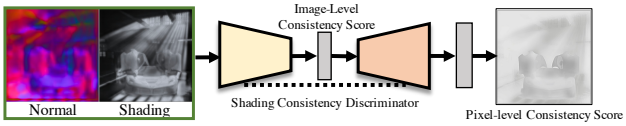


Figure 4. **Shading consistency discriminator** penalizes shading, if it is not consistent with the cut-and-paste normals at both image-level and pixel-level.

and 1 outside. Our reconstruction loss for the background is:

$$\mathcal{L}_{recons} = \|\mathcal{I}_t \odot \mathcal{M} - (f_\theta(\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s; \mathcal{I}_t; s); \mathcal{M}))\|^2 \quad (3)$$

We then pass the DIP rendered image through the image decomposition network g_ϕ making $\mathcal{A}_r$, $\mathcal{S}_r$ and $\mathcal{G}_r$ for the albedo, shading and gloss respectively. Our consistent image decomposition inference losses to train DIP are:

$$\mathcal{L}_{decomp} = \|\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)} - \mathcal{A}_r\|^2 + \|\mathcal{S}_t \odot \mathcal{M} - \mathcal{S}_r \odot \mathcal{M}\|^2 + \|\mathcal{G}_t \odot \mathcal{M} - \mathcal{G}_r \odot \mathcal{M}\|^2 \quad (4)$$

3.2. Shading Consistency Losses

We use two shading consistency losses to make the strong structure of a shading field apparent to a DIP's reshading. There is good evidence that shading is tied across surface normals (this underlies spherical harmonic models [31, 55]), and one should think of a surface normal as a latent variable that explains shading similarities. We assume the resulting illumination approximated with the first 9 spherical harmonics basis coefficients (Y) and does not change when an object is inserted into a scene. We get Y by solving the least square regression between normals ($\mathcal{N}$) and shading ($\mathcal{S}$) for both the target scene and the resulting composite image. We then minimize loss ($\mathcal{L}_Y$) between the target and rendered image $Y(\mathcal{S}; \mathcal{N})$. We use Huber loss for $\mathcal{L}_Y$.

$$\mathcal{L}_Y = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2}(Y(\mathcal{S}_t;\mathcal{N}_t) - Y(\mathcal{S}_r;\mathcal{N}_{\mathcal{CP}}))^2 & \text{for} |Y_t - Y_r| \leq 1 \\ |Y(\mathcal{S}_t;\mathcal{N}_t) - Y(\mathcal{S}_r;\mathcal{N}_{\mathcal{CP}})| - \frac{1}{2} & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (5)$$

Spherical harmonic shading fields have some disadvantages: every point with the same normal must have the same shading value, which results in poor models of (say) indoor shading on walls. To control this effect, we use a novel neural shading consistency loss ($\mathcal{L}_Z$) that allows the shading field to depart from a spherical harmonic shading field, but only in ways consistent with past inferences. Our shading consistency discriminator, $\zeta(\mathcal{S}; \mathcal{N})$, is a U-Net [46] (Fig. 4); trained to discriminate real and fake shading-normal pairs. $\zeta(\mathcal{S}; \mathcal{N})$ produces two outputs: one a pixel-level map, yielding the first loss term in Eq. 6, which measures per-pixel consistency; the other an image-level value, the second term in Eq. 6, which measures consistency for the entire image. The $\mathcal{L}_Z$ loss is a binary cross-entropy loss. Let $m \times n$ be the resolution of our renderings, then $\mathcal{L}_Z$ is given by

$$\mathcal{L}_Z = -\sum_{i=1}^{m}\sum_{j=1}^{n} \log \zeta(\mathcal{S}_r[i,j]; \mathcal{N}_{\mathcal{CP}}[i,j]) - log\zeta(\mathcal{S}_r\mathcal{N}_{\mathcal{CP}}) \quad (6)$$

In summary, we update DIPR with

$$\mathcal{L}_r = \mathcal{L}_{recons} + \mathcal{L}_{decomp} + \mathcal{L}_Y + \mathcal{L}_Z \quad (7)$$

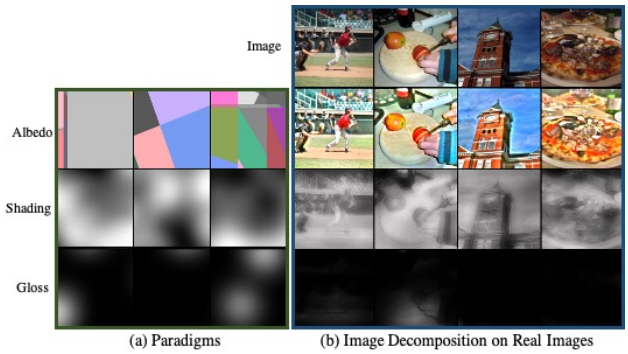


Figure 5. **Image decomposition.** Left: samples drawn from our *paradigms* that are used to train our image decomposition network. Right: examples showing MS COCO image decompositions.

3.3. Intrinsic Image Decomposition

We could use any competent image decomposition network for reshading. However, we find accurate albedo recovery (measured by strong WHDR performance) results in poor reshading outcomes (Fig 7). It is also helpful to have a small and efficient network to reduce the rendering time when training a DIPR. Therefore, we trained a small U-Net to produce albedo, shading, and gloss fields from images using **paradigms** [13], samples from statistical models intended to capture the spatial statistics of albedo, gloss and shading. This is a simple extension of the Retinex model [26]. Albedo paradigms are Mondrian images. Shading paradigms are Perlin noise [43], and gloss paradigms comprise light bars on a dark background. These are used to produce fake images by a simple composition ($\mathcal{AS} + \mathcal{G}$) that in turn are used to train the image decomposition network. Fig. 5a shows some samples from each. As Fig. 5b illustrates, the resulting intrinsic image models are satisfactory on MSCOCO [35] real images. For our experiments, we trained two models (*Paradigm I* and *Paradigm II)*; samples drawn from different statistical models, to investigate the consequences of strong WHDR recovery. The difference between the two is that Paradigm I has high-frequency, fine-grained details in albedo and not shading, and for Paradigm II, it is the opposite.

3.4. Post-Processing

Removing DIP artifacts. The input to DIPR are both the target scene and the cut-and-paste image. We let DIP inpaint the shading of the original target image *and* also the composited image for the masked region. This is analogous to rendering scenes twice *with* and *without* inserted object [10, 21]. Doing so means the target scene's shading field acts like a regularizer that prevents DIP copying cut-and-paste. Furthermore, we can remove DIP (network) specific noisy artifacts. We write $\mathcal{I}_{obj}$ for the target image rendered by DIP with the object and $\mathcal{I}_{noobj}$ for the target scene rendered without object, we then form

$$\mathcal{I}_{final} = (1 - \mathcal{M}) \odot \mathcal{I}_{obj} + \mathcal{M} \odot (\mathcal{I}_t + \mathcal{I}_{obj} - \mathcal{I}_{noobj}) \quad (8)$$

Target Scene CP IH [9] DIPR (ours)

Figure 6. **Rendering spheres.** DIPR has some implicit notion of the 3D layout of the scene, which is required to choose the appropriate shading. DIPR shades the white discs as spheres (rather better than IH, implying it "knows" about shape; also see Fig. 14).

High-resolution rendering. Our decomposition network can decompose high-resolution albedos reliably when trained only 128p Paradigms. Since our shading and gloss are both locally smooth for Paradigm I (fine details in albedo), we can easily upsample them to high-resolution. Thus we can render a very high-resolution (1024p) composites, without significant loss of detail.

4. Experiments

Scenes and objects. We collected about 100 diverse images with spatially varying illumination, both indoors-outdoors, day-night, to act as target scenes in our experiments. 25 of these scenes are captured by placing a spherical lampshade, which we use as ground truth for quantitative evaluation. We first test DIPR by inserting simple 2D bright disks at various locations in target scenes (Fig. 6). We also show reshading results for real cars inserted into our target scenes (Fig. 9). We also tested DIPR with complex surface properties – a lego dozer, a plant, a chair, and a set of sixteen materials with different reflective properties used in NeRF [38] (Fig. 10). Other objects from [31] are in our Appendix. We use ADE20K validation set [57] for supplying real residual loss to our image decomposition network and also to train our shading consistency network. ADE20K does not have ground truth normals and we use normals from [40].

Training details. We used U-Net for DIP, Image Decomposition and Shading Consistency Network. Network architecture and other training details are in our supplementary. We update our DIP for a fixed 10k iterations and this takes about 900 seconds using our image decomposition network and 1600 seconds when using CGIntrinsic [30].

IH baseline. We use Cong *et al.*'s DoveNet [9] and their provided pretrained model for our IH baseline.

Quantitative comparison to ground truth. We compare 25 photographs of a spherical lampshade with DIPR based insertions. We get insertions by placing a white disk over the lampshade, reshading the disk using DIPR, then multiplying by lampshade's albedo (a favorable case as it correctly rendered cast shadows). We then quantitatively compare results with ground truth (the real lampshade) using PSNR, LPIPS or MSE (Tab. 1; Fig. 1, Fig. 8). Fig. 1 (b) and (c) are real.

Shading ($\mathcal{S}$)	Albedo ($\mathcal{A}$)	LPIPS[56] ↓	PSNR ↑	MSE ↓
1	1	0.0105	30.81	102.52
$\mathcal{S}_r$	1	**0.0070**	**34.26**	**44.09**
IH [9]	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	0.2790	23.72	283.56
IH* [9]	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	0.0072	35.57	26.85
0.25	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	0.0113	26.74	188.55
0.50	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	0.0060	31.28	70.51
0.75	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	0.0032	38.18	16.04
1.0	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	0.0043	36.66	25.11
$\mathcal{S}_r$	$\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$	**0.0021**	**39.53**	**11.11**

Table 1. **Quantitative Evaluation on Spherical Lampshades** (Fig. 8). Cases: fixed shading fields ($\mathcal{S}$ is constant); fixed albedo fields ($\mathcal{A}$ constant); cut-and-paste albedo fields ($\mathcal{A}_{\mathcal{CP}(\mathcal{I}_s;\mathcal{I}_t;s)}$); image harmonization (IH); and our reconstruction ($\mathcal{S}_r$). Because IH changes the background, we also report the case where the metric is applied only to the inserted object as IH* (more favorable for IH). Other cases do not change the background. Note DIPR reshading wins in all metrics. Note such comparisons to ground truth occur in circumstances favorable to a method like ours (because the shading around the object is consistent), but we know of no way to avoid this. DIPR reshading has strong improvements for all metrics and shows our reshading are close to the actual photographed object.

$\mathcal{L}_{decomp}$(Eq. 4)	$\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{Y}}$ (Eq. 5)	$\mathcal{L}_{\mathcal{Z}}$(Eq. 6)	LPIPS[56] ↓	PSNR ↑	MSE ↓
✓			0.0026	37.89	15.72
✓		✓	0.0023	38.74	13.08
✓	✓		0.0022	39.09	11.47
✓	✓	✓	**0.0021**	**39.53**	**11.11**

Table 2. **Ablation** over losses show each helps improve reshading.

Fooling users. For evaluating how reliably our images are preferred, we conducted two user studies — one for synthetic objects and the other for real lampshades. For synthetic, we conducted a user study to compare DIPR, CP, and IH renderings. Each study comprises a pre-qualifying process (details in Appendix), followed by 9 pair-wise comparisons, where the user is asked which of two images are more realistic. The result is 109 pre-qualified studies. The comparisons are balanced. Each study is 3 DIPR-IH pairs, 3 CP-IH pairs, and 3 DIPR-CP pairs, in random order.

The simplest analysis strongly supports DIPR is preferred over both alternatives. One compares the probability that DIPR is preferred to IH (.673, over 327 comparisons, so standard error is .026, and the difference from 0.5 is clearly significant); DIPR is preferred to CP (.645, over 327 comparisons, so the standard error is .026, and the difference from 0.5 is clearly significant); IH is preferred to CP (.511, over 327 comparisons, so standard error is .027, and there is no significant difference from 0.5). An alternative is a Bradley-Terry model [52, 9] used in IH evaluation, regressing the quality predicted by the Bradley-Terry model against the class of algorithm. This yields coefficients of 0 for IH, -0.347 for CP, and 0.039 for DIPR, implying again that

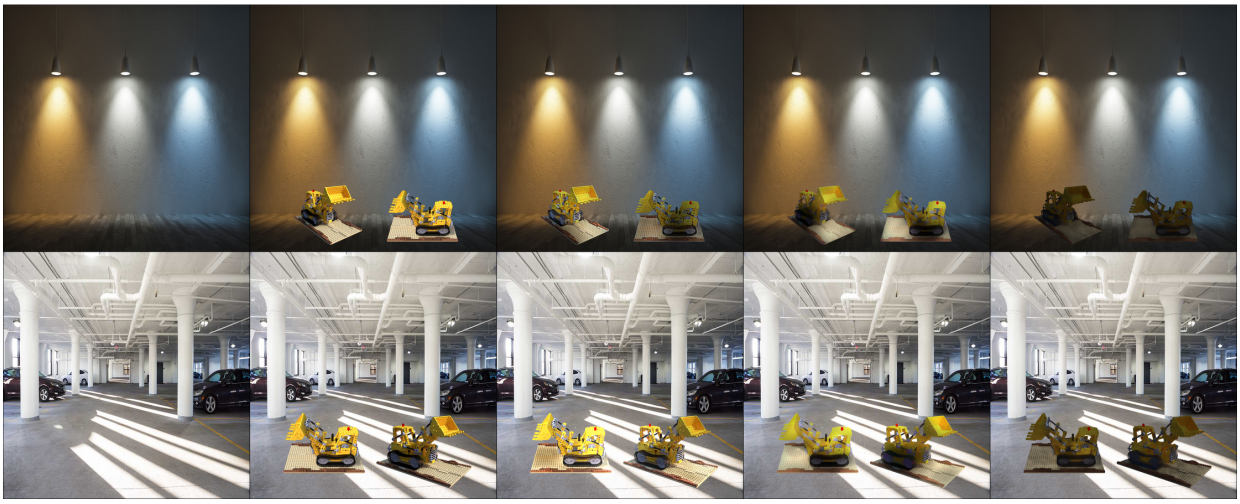


Figure 7. Better WHDR does not mean better reshading. Reshaded images when using target inferences from different decomposition models. Paradigm I achieves (relatively weak) WHDR of 22%; Paradigm II achieves 19%, close to SOTA for an image decomposition that does not see rendered images [37]. However, Paradigm II produces significantly worse reshading. Furthermore, reshading using a supervised SOTA[30] is also qualitatively worse than using Paradigm I. This reflects that better recovery of albedo, as measured by WHDR, does not produce better reshading. The key issue is that methods that get low WHDR do so by suppressing small spatial details in the albedo field (for example, the surface detail on the lego dozer), and the shading inference method cannot recover these details, and so they do not appear in final rendering. From the perspective of reshading, it is better to model them as fine detail in albedo than in shading.

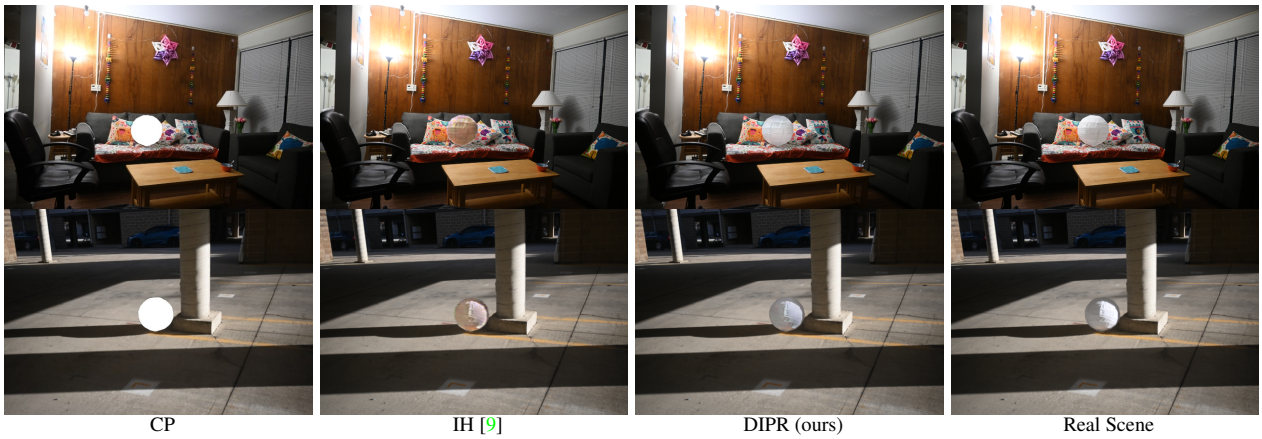


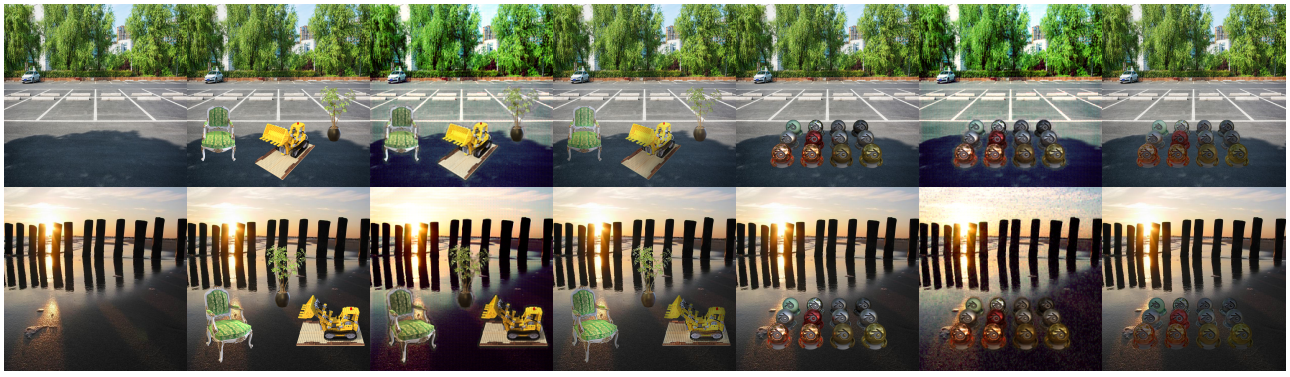
Figure 8. **Reshading spherical lampshades.** Similar to Fig. 6, we generate sphere rendering by overlaying 2D white disks over the real sphere from the photograph. We then use DIPR to reshade the overlaid 2D disk and combine that with the actual albedo (as they remain same irrespective of lighting) into a final rendering. IH copies average color. Our renderings are close to the ground truth (also see Tab. 1).

DIPR is preferred over IH and strongly preferred over CP.

How useful are quantitative evaluations? The gold standard evaluation here is user studies (after all, the goal is to fool people). However, user studies are a poor way to polish a method, and a proxy would be valuable. For images of the spherical lampshade used in the quantitative evaluation of Tab. 1, we asked users to identify which of the two presented images (showing distinct scenes, but both containing the lampshade) was real. One image presented was always a rendering, the other always real. Users each see 16 pairs, and there were 72 participants performing this study. Our DIPR renderings are very good at fooling users (50% is a chance). They pick DIPR 42.7% of the time. We then use logistic regression to predict each rendered image's probability of being marked real against MSE, PSNR and LPIPS. An accurate regression would mean that we had a score of "realness". However, such a model explains almost none of the variation of the data (null deviance: 17.87, residual deviance: 17). This means that, while it is pleasant that DIPR has strong MSE, PSNR, and LPIPS scores, these scores can not be used to predict user preferences for our task. As a result, evaluating MSE, PSNR and LPIPS against (say) synthesized data is unlikely to be helpful, and we did not do so. However, we show a qualitative comparison to SOTA methods that require a geometric and physical model which are rendered using their predicted environment map in Fig. 12.

Target Scene CP IH [9] DIPR (ours) CP IH [9] DIPR (ours)

Figure 9. **Reshading real cars.** Glossy effects in car paint with glitter in them make reshading cars a particularly challenging case with their complex reflective properties. DIPR successfully reshades cars without a distinct shift in object and background color produced by IH. Note the bright patch on the metallic bonnet of the grey car in the top row that may possibly be because of the light source just above it.



Target Scene CP IH [9] DIPR (ours) CP IH [9] DIPR (ours)

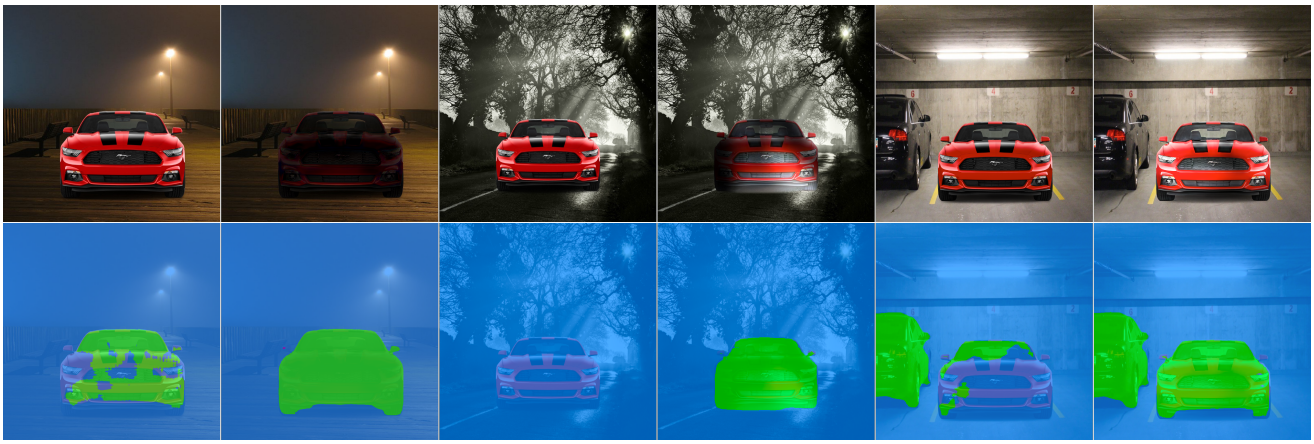
Figure 10. **Reshading complex sufaces.** DIPR reshades objects with complex surface geometry and complex material properties convincingly, and appears to preserve the identity of the material without a distinct shift in object and background color produced by IH.

Target Scene CP IH [9] $\mathcal{L}_{recons} + \mathcal{L}_{decomp}$ $+\mathcal{L}_Z$ $+\mathcal{L}_Z + \mathcal{L}_Y$

Figure 11. **Ablation Study.** We show the role of each of the loss components. Results improve from left to right (see the lego dozer). We find neural shading consistency loss ($\mathcal{L}_Z$) helps in improving local changes based on the near-by surroundings and spherical harmonics matching loss ($\mathcal{L}_Y$) considers the overall lighting providing complementary solutions. Tab. 2 has quantitative analysis for losses.

Target Scene Barron *et al.* [2] Gardner *et al.* [14] Garon *et al.* [16] Li *et al.* [29] DIPR (ours) Simulated GT

Figure 12. Qualitative comparison with SOTA image insertion methods (which require a geometric and physical model of the inserted objects – the bunnies – and the predicted lighting map for target scene). We can choose which image we cut the bunnies out of, and for the top DIPR image we use Barron's rendering; for the bottom, we use Gardner's rendering (other choices in Appendix). DIPR produces plausible shadings in each case, but is outperformed by methods that have access to detailed models of illumination and surface models.



Cut-and-Paste DIPR (ours) Cut-and-Paste DIPR (ours) Cut-and-Paste DIPR (ours)

Figure 13. **Instance segmentation.** DIPR rendered images produce consistent and accurate segmentation maps (bottom row). We observe segmentation fails for cut-and-paste images often. Our key intuition is that the instance segmentation network inherently "knows" if the object's placement is natural or not and expects the foreground object to have consistent shading with the background. If the object's shading does not match with that of the background then the resulting segmentation output would not segment out the object completely.

5. Discussion and Conclusions

Image Decomposition Network. Fig. 7 explains how better albedo recovery can lead to weaker reshading. Paradigm I achieves realistic reshading and we use image decomposition model trained on Paradigm I for all our experiments.

Consistent Instance Segmentation. We cannot quantitatively evaluate our reshading method when we do not know the ground truth. But we can test whether standard image tasks (which likely benefit from structural consistency in images) perform better on our images. We observe image segmentation methods (we used [8]) seem to prefer our images (Fig 13) compared to naïve cut-and-paste. We believe instance segmentation network inherently "knows" if the object's placement is natural or not and hence requires the foreground object to be consistent with the background. If not, the segmentation would produce inconsistent results. Our findings are also consistent with Ghiasi *et al.*[18], who show cut-and-paste is a strong data augmentation method for the instance segmentation. Previous models trained without this augmentation, such as [8] are sensitive to cut-and-paste images if the inserted fragments contradict the background's shading. This suggests downstream standard image analysis tasks can serve as a proxy evaluation to further polish reshading methods and also DIPR data augmentations could further improve various recognition tasks.

Reshadings are Derived From Consistent Shapes. DIPR renderings of circles look like spheres, suggesting the method has some notion of shape. We test if our shadings are consistent, using two procedures: a large scale using singular values and explicit reconstruction (expensive in compute) at a small scale. Results suggest there is indeed some emergent notion of shape, obtained with no shape annotated data.

(a) **Large scale:** Imagine we have many different re-

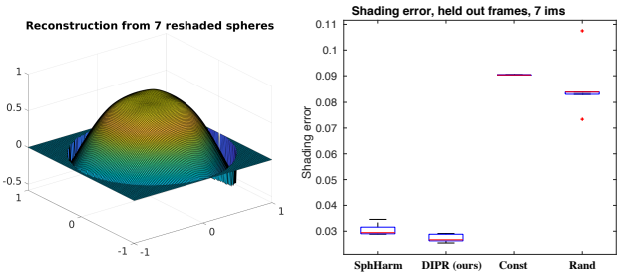


Figure 14. **Shape theory and shading consistency:** On the **left** a sample surface reconstruction produced by using 7 reshaded spheres (Fig. 6). On the right, predicted shading residuals for held out spheres' shadings using our reconstructed shapes. The residuals suggest: there is a consistent underlying shape. Our DIPR residuals are small. The reconstruction process is reliable but the underlying surface is not quite a sphere. 'SphHarm' residuals are also small, but not as small as DIPR. 'Const' residuals are large. Therefore, underlying surface is not flat. Smooth 'Rand' residuals are large, that is, random shadings cannot explain this consistency.

shadings $S_{i,k}$ of a particular inserted shape (we use white circles in albedo). It is known that multiple shadings of the same geometry have important similarities [3]. Assume that the shading value $S_{i,k}(\mathbf{x})$ is a slowly changing spatial function of the (unknown) normal $\mathbf{N}(\mathbf{x})$, so that $S_{i,k}(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{m=1}^{N_s} a_{m,k}(\mathbf{x})\phi_m(\mathbf{N}(\mathbf{x}))$. Assume here that k is small, and $a_{m,k}(\mathbf{x})$ are spatially slow. These assumptions apply to, for example, spherical harmonic shading of diffuse surfaces [45]) and shading using the spherical gaussian basis of [29]. Now straighten each image into a vector $\mathbf{S}_{i,k}$. Then these vectors span a N_s dimensional space. Form $\mathcal{D}_i = \left[\mathbf{S}_{i,1}^T, \ldots, \mathbf{S}_{i,N_o}\right]$ (where $N_o > N_s$). We expect the singular values σ_r of $\mathcal{M}_i$ to be small for $r > N_s$ if all the $\mathbf{S}_{i,j}$ are shadings of the same scene, and large if they are not. Using these observations to make a test of consistency

Images	NIQE [39]↓	CNN-D [54]↓	B-T [9]↑
IH	38.39	0	0
CP	**9.67**	0	-0.35
DIPR (ours)	9.78	0	**0.04**
Target Scene	12.51	0	NA

Table 3. Additional quantitative Analysis for plants, lego, 16-set materials and cars when no ground truth is available. We report numbers for a no-reference image quality estimator (NIQE), a CNN-based tampering detector (CNN-D) and Bradley-Terry (BT) model's analysis from the user-study. Surprisingly, NIQE is worse for target scenes, CNN-D cannot detect any image as fake, and from the user study between three methods, BT analysis shows our reshaded images are preferred over CP and IH.

requires knowing what is a "small" singular value, and what N_s and N_o should be. We use $N_s = 14$ and 200 sample points on each shading field. We now draw 10000 sets of N_s reshadings from our examples, and look at the test statistic $T = \frac{\Pi_{r=10}^{14}\sigma_r}{\sigma_0^5}$. We see a mean of 0.21 and a standard deviation of 7.4×10^{-2} for T, which appears to be normally distributed. We compare this with a baseline of randomly chosen shading from natural scenes (cropped to the 2D disk). This yields a mean of 0.66 and a standard deviation of 5.9×10^{-2}. We conclude DIPR reshadings of spheres are strongly different from random shading and display a degree of shape consistency.

(b) Explicit shape reconstruction: We produce explicit reconstructions of our inserted circles. We take 7 reshaded circles, each from two different images. From this pool of 14, we draw 7 at random, use them to drive a shape reconstruction procedure (see Appendix; a typical reconstruction in Fig. 14). We then compute the spherical harmonic reshading of the resulting reconstruction that is closest to each of the 7 held out images and record the mean squared error of the shading residual for each. A small residual means that the shape is consistent across the reshaded circles. Box plots of the resulting residuals for 7 different splits of the data in Fig. 14. To calibrate, we compare this with 3 baselines; we reshade: (1) a sphere using actual spherical harmonic shading, reconstruct from reshadings, then predict the held out reshadings ('SphHarm'), (2) a constant height surface ('Const') and (3) a surface reconstructed from smoothed random noise shadings ('Rand'). These residuals and singular value analysis suggest the reshading network has some form of shape theory as an emergent property.

Limitations. DIPR is slow because DIP takes 15 mins to render. DIPR cannot cast shadows; very hard and we leave that for our future work. DIPR likely copies shading, so has problems when there is little shading variation and responds poorly when there are "few" normals in the scene (Fig. 15).

Why DIPR works? Corrections to object shading cannot be veridical. [33, 34] finds corrected shading often fool humans more effectively than physically accurate lighting, likely because humans attend to complex materials much more than to consistent lighting [5]. The alternative physics theory [7] argues that the brain employs a set of rules that are convenient, but not strictly physical and a violation leads to perception alarm or affects recognition negatively [17]. Otherwise, the scene "looks right". This means humans may tolerate a fair degree of error, as long as it is of the right kind. By requiring image to produce consistent inferences, we appear to be forcing errors to be "of the right kind".

Cut-and-Paste DIPR (ours) Cut-and-Paste DIPR (ours)

Figure 15. **Failure cases.** Red arrows point to shading errors. In first image, DIPR aggressively copies background shading onto the chair. However, lego's and plant's shading looks plausible. In the second scene, it has two dominant normals – the ground (upwards) and the sky (towards viewer). The lack of third direction results in copying shading either from the sky or the ground.

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